

CANA

O F G A L I L E E

BRAND IDENTITY GUIDE

Heirloom ceramics for the Christian home

Working draft v1 • June 2026

Internal document — strategy, verbal & visual system

Contents

(In Word: right-click → Update Field to populate page numbers.)

1. Cana at a glance

One quiet idea: Scripture, carved into clay — treasure in jars of clay.

What it is	A premium direct-to-consumer ceramics brand for the Christian home — mugs, plates, serveware, and candle-light pieces, each carrying a line of Scripture pressed into the clay itself.
The promise	An everyday object made sacred: a blessing you can hold, use, and give — made to be kept, not thrown away.
Who it's for	Affluent Protestant (especially evangelical & mainline) women, roughly 55–75, in North America, who buy gifts often and decorate their homes in their faith.
Where it sells	Direct-to-consumer via Meta (Facebook & Instagram), gift-led, with seasonal tent-poles (Advent, Easter, Mother's Day).
Price world	Accessible-premium: blessing tokens from ~\$14–22, mugs ~\$32–42, gift sets ~\$68–110, a signature light piece ~\$58–78.
Why it wins	It owns the gap no one holds: genuinely beautiful, craft-elevated, and openly Christian — between cheap kitsch (Hobby Lobby, DaySpring) and secular minimal ceramics.

This guide is a working system, not scripture itself. It exists so that every mug, caption, box, and ad feels like it came from one hand. Where a decision is still open, it is flagged honestly in Section 10.

2. Brand foundation

2.1 The name and what it means

Cana is the village in Galilee where Jesus performed his first miracle — turning water into wine at a wedding feast (John 2). It is a story of the table, of hospitality, of abundance, and of the ordinary made beautiful: plain water becomes the finest wine, and the everyday becomes the occasion of grace. For a brand that puts beauty and blessing on the objects of daily life, no story fits better.

The fuller mark reads “Cana of Galilee,” the way the Gospel names it (John 2:1). “Galilee” roots the brand in a real, humble, sacred place — the unglamorous region where Jesus chose to begin everything — and works like a place-of-origin signature on the base of each piece.

A deliberate restraint: we lead with the table, the feast, and abundance — never with wine imagery. Our core customer includes many who abstain from alcohol, and the story’s meaning (transformation, generosity, the everyday made holy) carries beautifully without a single wine glass.

2.2 Origin narrative (draft)

Cana was born from a simple conviction: that the things we use every morning — the cup, the plate, the table we gather around — are quietly sacred, and ought to be beautiful enough to keep. We make heirloom ceramics with a line of Scripture pressed into the clay, so the word is something you hold in your hands and pass to the people you love. Like the water made wine at Cana, we believe the ordinary can be made lovely.

(Founder’s personal story to be added once Valle decides how visible he wants to be. A real founder voice — even brief — measurably lifts trust and conversion in faith DTC.)

2.3 Mission & promise

- **Mission.** To make the word a thing you can hold — beautiful objects that carry Scripture into the rhythm of an ordinary day.
- **Promise.** Every Cana piece is craft-made, made to be kept, and ready to give. We carve, we do not print. We bless, we do not preach.

2.4 Brand pillars

Four pillars govern every decision. If something serves none of them, it doesn’t belong to Cana.

Pillar	What it means in practice
Heirloom, not merch	Materials and finishes that justify being kept and handed down. No throwaway feel, no fast-fashion novelty.
Legibly Christian	The faith is clear and spoken, never hidden — but expressed with craft and restraint, never kitsch.
Hospitality	Built for the table, the gift, the welcome. The brand is a gracious host, not a billboard.
The ordinary made sacred	We dignify daily use — the morning cup, the shared meal — rather than chasing

Pillar	What it means in practice
	decoration for its own sake.

2.5 The customer — and who she is not

Meet “Ruth.”

She is 62, lives in the American South or Midwest, and is comfortably well-off. She is an active churchgoer — evangelical or mainline Protestant — and her faith is woven through her home: a verse by the front door, a devotional on the nightstand. She buys gifts constantly: for grandchildren’s baptisms, for church friends, for Mother’s Day, for a grieving neighbor. She is on Facebook daily. She is not cheap, but she is discerning — she can tell Hobby Lobby from something made with care, and she is quietly tired of the first. She buys on feeling: encouragement, comfort, family, faith.

Critical honesty about who Cana is NOT built for (at least at launch):

- **Not:** The 28–40 secular-minimalist “design Christian.” She’d want the faith whispered, not spoken — a different brand. Chasing her dilutes the wedge.
- **Not:** The bargain shopper. If price is the deciding factor, Cana will lose to Amazon and Hobby Lobby — and shouldn’t try to win there.
- **Not:** The general home-decor buyer with no faith frame. Our targeting and meaning both depend on the Christian identity.

2.6 Positioning

The market splits into two crowded poles. Cana occupies the empty middle: premium craft + open faith.

	Faith visibility	Craft / price	Examples
Cheap & kitsch	Loud, overt	Low, printed decals	Hobby Lobby, Christian Art Gifts, much of DaySpring
Secular & premium	None	High, design-led	East Fork, Year & Day, artisan potters
CANA — the gap	Open & warm	High, carved/heirloom	(unoccupied — our position)

Räder (the German poetic gifting house) is our business-model reference: a price ladder of giftable objects with a Christmas/seasonal engine — not a platter-led tableware company. We borrow the model and the craft; we reject the cool, vague-spiritual European temperature in favor of warmth and explicit faith.

2.7 Personality & voice in one line

If Cana were a person: a gracious, well-read host who sets a beautiful table, knows her Scripture by heart, and makes everyone feel welcome — warm, calm, quietly confident, never showy, never preachy.

3. Verbal identity

3.1 Voice & tone

- **Be:** Warm and hospitable — we speak like a gracious host, not a salesperson or a pulpit.
- **Be:** Literate and unhurried — simple, lovely sentences. We trust Scripture and craft to do the work.
- **Be:** Reverent but light — faith held with gladness, not heaviness or guilt.
- **Avoid:** Preachy, pushy, or guilt-driven. No “share your faith or else,” no urgency manipulation.
- **Avoid:** Cutesy, exclamatory, or clichéd (“Blessed beyond measure!!”, “live-laugh-love” energy).

3.2 Tagline & descriptor

Primary line (the brand’s own verse — it is literally what Cana is):

“We have this treasure in jars of clay.” — 2 Corinthians 4:7

Working descriptor (for clarity in ads / bios): “Heirloom ceramics for the Christian home.”

Alternate lines to test: “Scripture, carved in clay.” · “The everyday, made sacred.” · “A blessing you can hold.” · “Set a place for grace.”

3.3 Words we use / words we avoid

Use	Avoid
blessing, carved, kept, heirloom, gather, table, home, the everyday, made by hand, treasure	blessed beyond measure, faith-filled, on-trend, cheap, deal, hustle, must-have
the word, Scripture, a verse for..., give, welcome, mercy, peace	preach, convert, sinner, guilt, “share or else”
abundance, the feast, the first miracle, water made wine (as story)	wine, a glass of..., cheers, happy hour, vineyard-as-drinking

Note the third row: the Cana story may be told (the miracle, the feast, abundance), but alcohol/wine as a product or image is off-limits for our audience.

3.4 How we write Scripture

- Quote accurately and cite the reference (e.g., “Psalm 46:10”). Accuracy is non-negotiable with this audience.
- Default translation: a warm, familiar register — ESV or NIV for modern pieces; KJV where the cadence is beloved (“It is well...”). Decide per piece, stay consistent within a collection.
- On the product: short phrases, not long passages — the carved line must read at a glance and fit the form.

4. The Scripture canon

Consistency lives in the treatment (how every verse is carved); variety lives in the verse. We do not put the same verse on everything, nor a random verse on each piece. We draw from a tight, curated canon, matched to what each object is for. Start small — prove demand — then expand.

Starter canon (launch set):

Verse	Line (short form)	Theme	Object / occasion
Joshua 24:15	As for me and my house, we will serve the Lord	The home	Entry/wall piece, housewarming
Psalms 46:10	Be still, and know	Quiet, trust	Mug, morning ritual
Lamentations 3:22-23	His mercies are new every morning	Renewal	Mug, coffee/tea, comfort
Numbers 6:24-26	The Lord bless you and keep you	Blessing	Platter, gift set, farewell
Isaiah 41:10	Fear not, for I am with you	Comfort	Encouragement gift, sympathy
2 Corinthians 4:7	Treasure in jars of clay	The brand verse	Signature piece / base mark

Seasonal capsules extend the canon a few times a year: Advent (Isaiah 9:6, “unto us a child is born”), Easter (“He is not here; he is risen”), Mother’s Day (Proverbs 31, “her children rise up and call her blessed”). Capsules drive urgency and repeat purchase — the Räder engine.

Discipline note (critical): every verse × every object is a separate SKU to make, stock, and photograph. Resist proliferation. For the smoke test, 3–4 verses across one or two gift sets is plenty.

5. Visual identity

5.1 Logo system

The marks share one olive-and-serif language and are designed to be pressed into clay, embossed on paper, or printed flat — never to compete with the carved Scripture on the front of a piece.

- **Wordmark.** Wordmark — “CANA” in an elegant high-contrast classical serif, wide letter-spacing. The primary identity; carries the brand on its own.
- **Primary mark.** Primary mark — a compact circle with a small olive sprig above “CANA.” The everyday maker’s mark; use on small pieces, social avatar, anywhere space is tight.
- **Coin mark.** Coin / signature mark — a double-ring stamp reading “CANA” over the top and “GALILEE” along the bottom with a center sprig. For larger pieces, packaging, and the website — only where big enough to keep “GALILEE” legible.

Application on ceramics: the mark is impressed into the unglazed base of the piece, tone-on-tone, no ink — the same “pressed into clay” language as the carved Scripture. Never print a logo on the visible front.

Clear space & size: keep clear space equal to the height of the “C” on all sides. Minimum legible size: primary mark ~12 mm; coin mark ~20 mm (below this, drop “GALILEE”). Working vector files: `cana_mark_primary.svg` and `cana_mark_coin.svg` (in the project folder). These are first-pass; final art should be redrawn/cleaned by a designer and the licensed serif outlined before tooling a physical stamp.

Logo don’ts: don’t stretch or recolor outside the palette; don’t add a cross/fish/dove; don’t place on busy photos; don’t print glossy on the product face; don’t use the coin where it will blur.

5.2 Color palette

Warm and earthy — the colors of clay, linen, olive, and candlelight. Foundation tones dominate; accents are used sparingly.

	Bone #F4EDDE	Foundation / the clay, paper, surfaces
	Linen #E7DAC4	Secondary ground / packaging
	Umber #54442F	Primary ink / the mark, carved shadow
	Espresso #3A2E20	Body text / deepest tone
	Olive #7C7A53	Primary accent / life, peace, the branch
	Antique Gold #B5934E	Precious accent / light, foil (sparing)
	Terracotta #B5683F	Warm seasonal accent (use rarely)

Usage ratio (roughly): 70% Bone/Linen grounds, 20% Umber/Espresso ink and type, 8% Olive, 2% Antique Gold. Terracotta is a rare seasonal warm note. Keep it disciplined — restraint is what reads premium.

Accessibility: Espresso on Bone and Umber on Bone both pass for body text. Never set Gold or Olive as small text on a light ground — use them for accents, rules, and large type only.

5.3 Typography

A two-part system, chosen for warmth and for legibility to older eyes: an elegant serif for display and Scripture, a clean humanist sans for body and web.

Role	Recommended typeface	Notes
Display / wordmark / verses	Cormorant Garamond (free, Google Fonts) — high-contrast, refined	Use for headlines, the carved-verse lettering reference, hero lines. Pair tightly; it's delicate, so not for small body text.
Alternate display	EB Garamond or Canela (paid) for a warmer / more premium feel	Test against Cormorant; choose one and stay consistent.
Body / web / packaging copy	A warm humanist sans — Work Sans or Inter (free)	Highly legible on screen and at small sizes for the 55–75 reader. Avoid thin weights.

Licensing: Google Fonts (Cormorant Garamond, EB Garamond, Work Sans, Inter) are free for commercial use, including embedding and merchandise. Paid faces (Canela) need a license — budget for it only once revenue justifies. For the physical carved lettering, the chosen serif must be converted to outlines before sending to a manufacturer.

5.4 The signature design mechanic: Scripture carved in clay

This is the heart of the brand and our most ownable asset. Rules:

- Carved or relief, never printed. The verse is pressed or raised in the clay so you can feel it — this is the craft step that separates Cana from decal kitsch.
- Tone-on-tone. The lettering is the same color as the piece (cream on cream); the shadow in the relief does the reading. Quiet, expensive, not loud.
- One letterform, everywhere. The same serif on every piece is what makes the whole range look related at a glance.
- Placement by form. Wraps a mug, sits across a platter, runs the rim of a bowl — always with generous space, never crowded.

5.5 Material, form & finish

- **Material.** Body: warm ivory/bone stoneware (not bright white). Honest, weighty, heirloom.
- **Finish.** Finish: matte-to-satin glaze on surfaces; unglazed, lightly tactile clay on the base where the maker’s mark is pressed.
- **Form.** Form: simple, generous, timeless silhouettes — nothing trendy that will date. Let the carved word be the only ornament.
- **Hero.** Hero mechanic: a pierced-light piece — a votive/luminary where a verse or cross is cut through the wall and glows by candlelight in the evening. The “wow” object and gift centerpiece.

5.6 The olive motif & secondary graphics

The olive branch (peace, the dove returning to Noah, the Mount of Olives, anointing oil) is our recurring graphic — on packaging, tissue, dividers, the website, and alongside verses. It is warm, premium, and — critically — carries no wine baggage. Keep it simple and naturalistic; never grapes or vines (too close to wine and too literal).

5.7 Photography & art direction

Do	Don't
Warm natural window light; morning and golden-hour	Cool/blue light, hard studio flash
Linen, raw wood, stone, ivory surfaces	Plastic, neon, glossy seamless white only
Props: bread, olives, figs, coffee/tea, candles, greenery, an open Bible, a set table, an older woman's hands	Wine glasses, alcohol, cluttered scenes, cheesy stock “Christian” clichés
The pierced-light piece glowing at dusk; gift unboxing; the table mid-gather	Overt church/altar staging; busy graphic overlays
Calm, sacred-ordinary, hospitable mood	Urgency banners, loud sale graphics on hero imagery

6. Product & range architecture

Built on the Räder ladder: a few accessible entry pieces that lift average order value through sets, with a hero object that makes the brand worth talking about. This structure also fixes the unit-economics problem — gift sets, not single mugs, carry the Meta acquisition math.

6.1 The price ladder

Tier	Example	Price	Role
Entry	Blessing token (small dish/ornament, short blessing)	\$14–22	Impulse, add-on, church bulk, list-builder
Core	Carved-verse mug; small plate	\$32–42	Everyday hero, repeat purchase
Gift set	Curated 2–3 piece sets (see 6.2)	\$68–110	The conversion engine — lead here in ads
Signature light	Pierced-light scripture luminary	\$58–78	The “wow” / shareable / Advent centerpiece
Statement	Carved platter / the “table” piece	\$90–140	Trust-builder, wedding & milestone gift

6.2 Gift-set architecture

- “Morning Mercies” — mug (Lam 3:22–23) + small tray + blessing token. The everyday-comfort gift.
- “Bless This House” — Joshua 24:15 wall/entry piece + token. The housewarming gift.
- “Be Still” — mug (Ps 46:10) + pierced-light votive. The rest/comfort gift and the hero pairing.

Each set arrives gift-ready (Section 7), so the buyer can send it straight to the recipient — a major convenience driver for this customer.

6.3 Verse → object logic

Verse matches the object's use, which is what makes a gift feel intentional: morning verses on mugs, blessing verses on serveware and gift pieces, house verses on entry/wall pieces, comfort verses on encouragement gifts. The brand verse (2 Cor 4:7) lives discreetly on the base or on a single signature piece.

6.4 Seasonal capsules

Three tent-poles a year carry most of the calendar: Advent (the light pieces shine here), Easter, and Mother's Day. Capsules are limited, dated, and collectible — they create urgency and bring customers back, exactly as Räder's Christmas engine does.

7. Packaging & the gift experience

For this customer, the unboxing IS the gift. Packaging is not an afterthought — it is a core part of the product and a major driver of perceived value and word-of-mouth.

- **Box.** A sturdy rigid box in Bone/Linen, olive sprig debossed, sealed with the coin mark or a wax seal (the primary mark).
- **Inside.** Tissue printed with the olive motif; a protective, considered fit — nothing rattles, nothing feels cheap.
- **The card.** A blessing card with every piece: the verse on one side, and 2–3 warm sentences on its meaning on the other. This teaches, raises perceived worth, and gives the gift its words.
- **Convenience.** “Ready to give” option at checkout: gift note + direct shipping to the recipient.

The blessing card is also your cheapest brand-builder and repeat-purchase hook — it can carry a quiet line about the next capsule or a code to gift again.

8. Brand guardrails — what Cana never does

These are the lines that protect the brand's position. Breaking them is how a premium faith brand slides into kitsch or into blandness.

- **Never:** Never use wine or alcohol imagery on products or in marketing (teetotal core audience).
- **Never:** Never print Scripture or logos as glossy decals on the visible face of a piece — we carve and emboss.
- **Never:** Never slap on a generic cross, fish, or dove as decoration — the olive branch is our restraint.
- **Never:** Never use platitude language ("blessed beyond measure") or loud sale/urgency graphics on hero imagery.
- **Never:** Never go cold, grey, and vaguely-spiritual to look 'designer' — warmth and explicit faith are the whole point.
- **Never:** Never compete on price or chase the bargain shopper — we lose there, and it cheapens the brand.
- **Never:** Never misquote Scripture or get a reference wrong — accuracy is trust with this audience.

9. Where the brand shows up

- **Social.** Instagram & Facebook: warm lifestyle imagery, the blessing-card verses as quote posts, behind-the-scenes of carving, gift-set flat-lays. Facebook is where the customer lives — weight it heavily.
- **Web.** Website: serif headlines, sans body, lots of Bone space, the coin mark in the header, verse-led product names, the brand verse on the About page.
- **Physical.** Product & packaging: the carved verse (front), the pressed maker's mark (base), the blessing card (inside).
- **Ads.** Ads: lead with gift sets and the light piece; warm imagery, no urgency clutter; occasion-led (“a gift for the friend who’s grieving” / “for her new home”).

10. Open decisions & honest next steps

This guide locks the identity. These items are deliberately unresolved and should be settled before spending on tooling or inventory — in roughly this order:

#	Decision / step	Why it matters
1	Run a formal USPTO trademark search (Class 21 housewares + Class 35 retail) on “Cana”	Knockout checks were clean, but candle/home “Cana” users exist; clear before filing or printing.
2	Secure cana lockup domain + matching @ handle	Grab thecanaco.com / canaceramics.com and the Instagram/Facebook handle together, now.
3	Resolve sourcing: father’s China factories vs. Portugal	Chinese ceramic tariffs run ~25–51% in 2026. Dad’s value is trust/QC/MOQs, not cheap landed cost — model the real per-unit math against gift-set pricing.
4	Finalize logo vector + commission a physical maker’s stamp	Designer cleans the marks, outlines the licensed serif, then a stamp/mold is made.
5	Choose translation policy & lock the 3–4 launch verses + first gift set	Keeps the smoke test small and the SKUs sane.
6	Phase-0 ad smoke test (~\$300–800) before any tooling	Run warm creative to a simple landing/email-capture page; measure real demand before buying inventory.

Asset inventory (project folder): *cana_mark_primary.svg*, *cana_mark_coin.svg*, this guide, and the Higgsfield logo renders (download from the Higgsfield results into the folder).

Sources informing this guide: Pew Research 2023–24 Religious Landscape Study; YouVersion top-verses data; competitive scan (DaySpring, Christian Art Gifts, Hosanna Revival, Willow Tree, Daily Grace Co.); naming/trademark knockout research; 2026 US ceramic tariff figures. Full detail in the project’s research notes.